

By STEVE WESTON
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TUCSON — University of Arizona's baseball team has its job clearly defined this weekend — keep a knockdown from turning into a knockout.

Coach Frank Sancet's Wildcats, on the ropes in the Western Athletic Conference Southern Division baseball chase, hope to regroup and get going again against the less-than-imposing Texas-El Paso Miners.

The teams meet tonight at Hi Corbett Field at 7:30, tomorrow at 1 o'clock at UA Field and tomorrow night at Hi Corbett (7:30).

UA swept three from UTEP earlier in El Paso, and absolutely MUST sweep this weekend.

The Wildcats (34-14, 5-4) lost a lot of ground in the division race last week when they were swept by Arizona State. And the Sun Devils (9-0) could just about put the title away this weekend at New Mexico — especially if UA should fail to sweep the Miners.

"Our kids aren't down despite the losses at ASU," Sancet commented. "I'm proud of them. If we get a few good bounces and help from somebody else, we can be right back in this thing."

Sancet said he'll go with senior righthander Bob Beach (6-2, 3.59 earned run average) tonight, Dave Breuker (4-3, 3.59) tomorrow afternoon and Jim Burnes (3-1, 3.67) tomorrow night.

UTEP coach Andy Cohen, whose team is 11-31 overall and far out of the Southern Division race at 0-9, will counter with righthanders Mike Beltran (1-6, 2.52), Tim Peden (2-7, 2.67) and Ray Greggerson (0-3, 4.54).

The Miners, who have given most everyone some trouble but haven't been able to win the close ones, will be led by Barry Alburdis (.386), Joe Kuenstler (.302) and Terry Baker (.295).

The earlier set in El Paso was not a pitcher's series — UA winning by 9-4, 3-2 and 9-7—and this weekend's meeting is not expected to be any different.

UA will take a .329 team batting average into the series, led by junior left-fielder Johnny Glenn, who is hitting .449 and is only eight hits shy of UA's single-season record for hits and three doubles away from equaling the school record.

Joining Glenn in the starting lineup will likely be Rick Coleman (.309) at first, Rudy Mendoza (.302) at second, Carlos Figueroa (.258) at shortstop, Bob Allen (.336) at third, Jim Filippelli (.356) in center and Herb Genung (.278)